Mile Marker #4: My Academic Toolkit

Every Pathfinder needs the right tools: not someone else's toolkit, but the ones that actually work for how you learn.

> This Mile Marker is about figuring out what that looks like for you. Not what worked for a classmate, not what a study guide says, but what works for you, in your real life, this semester.

> **Two ways to use this handout.** It matches the Mile Marker #4 assignment in Blackboard. Print it and fill it in by hand, or type in the boxes below and save a PDF. Either way, upload the photo, scan, or PDF to the assignment. You can also type your answers in Blackboard instead.

NAME _____ **DATE** _____

QUESTION 1

What study strategy, habit, or academic tool did you focus on this week, and why did you choose it?

Be specific about what it is and what made it worth trying. "I studied more" isn't specific. "I tried reviewing my notes out loud the night before class" is.

***A strong answer** names one specific strategy, habit, or tool and gives a real reason you chose it.*

The strategy, habit, or tool you focused on, and why you chose it

QUESTION 2

How did you actually use it, and what did you notice?

Did it help you understand, remember, or stay focused? Did anything surprise you, good or bad? Be honest about what happened, not what you hoped would happen.

***A strong answer** describes how you used it in a real class or task and at least one specific thing you noticed about your learning.*

How you used it, and what you noticed

QUESTION 3

Write one SMART goal for keeping a study strategy or habit from this module going for the rest of the semester.

This isn't asking for a perfect plan. It's asking for one honest goal that fits where you are right now.

***A strong answer** covers all five parts, names a real class or goal, and includes a clear way to tell whether you followed through.*

S: Specific. What exactly will you do?

M: Measurable. How will you know you did it?

A: Achievable. Why is it realistic for your life right now?

R: Relevant. Why this habit, and which class or goal does it help?

T: Time-bound. When, and how often?

QUESTION 4

Think about any AI tool you used this week, for this course or any other. Where would your use land on the AI Creep Meter?

Closer to brainstorming, closer to drafting or rewriting, or somewhere in between? Was that where you meant to land, or did it shift further than you planned? If you didn't use AI at all this week, that's a complete answer too. Just say so.

***A strong answer** says honestly where your AI use landed (or that you didn't use AI) and whether that was where you meant to land. Full credit doesn't depend on where you landed on the meter.*

THE AI CREEP METER



Brainstorming **Outlining** **Drafting** **Revising** **Rewriting** **Submitting**

Lower stakes *Higher stakes*

The farther AI moves into the creation of your work, the more important transparency becomes.

Where did your AI use land?

Choose one ☐ Brainstorming ☐ Outlining ☐ Drafting ☐ Revising ☐ Rewriting ☐ Submitting ☐ I didn't use AI this week

Was that where you meant to land, or did it shift further than you planned?